

THE PROTOCOL • 04

04 THE COACH CONVERSATION.

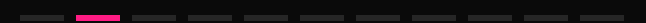
The fifteen-minute meeting most parents never have — until
something's wrong.

FIRST, A REFRAME

THE COACH ISN'T THE
ENEMY. SHE'S THE
THIRD CORNER.

Approach her as an adversary and you lose. Approach her as a partner — someone building the same thing you are — and the whole system unlocks.

— YOU'RE NOT THERE TO NEGOTIATE. YOU'RE THERE TO ALIGN.



WHEN & HOW

TIMING BEATS SCRIPT.

DO Before the season starts	DO Within the first two weeks	DO 15 minutes · in person if possible	DO Voice matters — phone call at minimum
DON'T Wait until there's a problem	DON'T Ambush after a game	DON'T Long email or text thread	DON'T Bring another parent along

THE ONE SENTENCE THAT SETS EVERYTHING

NOT THIS ↓

WHAT MOST PARENTS SAY

"I wanted to talk about my daughter."

THIS ↓

THE OPENING LINE

"I want to understand **what you're building this season** ,
so I can **support it at home.**"

IN THIS ORDER

EACH ONE DOES SPECIFIC WORK.

01

What are you building this season?

Gets you out of "my daughter" mode and into system mode. You want the coach's season-long thesis.

CENTERS THE COACH

02

What does growth look like for my daughter inside what you're building?

Maps your kid onto her plan. You'll hear things you didn't expect. Listen without arguing.

MAPS THE ATHLETE

03

What can I do from home that helps — and what should I not do?

The one coaches love. Gives her explicit permission to tell you to back off a specific behavior. Most of the time, she will.

ENLISTS THE PARENT

04

If something starts going sideways — how do you prefer I bring it up?

INSTALLS THE PROTOCOL

THE CIRCUIT BREAKER

YOU SET UP THE
HARD CONVERSATION
BEFORE YOU NEED IT.

Most coach blowups happen in the heat of a moment — after a game, in a text sent at 10pm, in an email CC'd to three parents. Q4 prevents all of that. You now have a [pre-agreed channel](#).

IF YOU WALK OUT AS A PARTNER

ACT LIKE ONE THE NEXT 40 WEEKS.

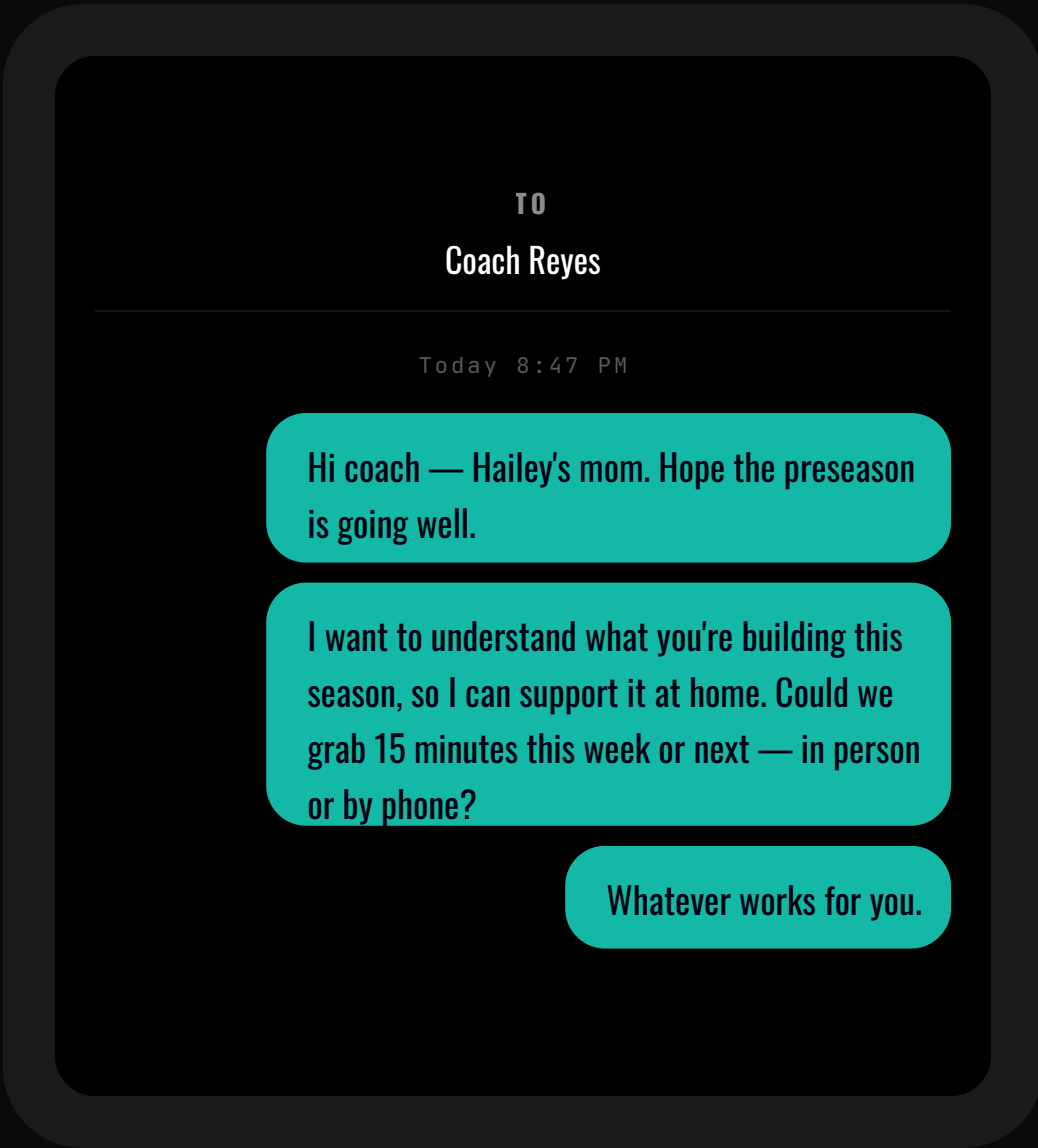
NOT YOUR JOB Coaching from the sideline	NOT YOUR JOB Critiquing her playing time
NOT YOUR JOB Campaigning for her position	NOT YOUR JOB Comparing her to another athlete
YOUR JOB Use the protocol from Q4	YOUR JOB Reinforce the coach's framework at home
YOUR JOB Keep the drive home about her, not the game	YOUR JOB Trust the season before you judge it

THE POCKET SCRIPT

SEND THIS TONIGHT.

One message. Drops the temperature, signals partnership, asks for the smallest possible commitment. Don't workshop it for ten days. Send it now — you'll talk yourself out of it by Saturday.

SCREENSHOT · SAVE · SEND



REALISTIC CONTINGENCIES

NOT EVERY COACH WILL SAY YES.

IF SHE SAYS "WE DON'T USUALLY DO PARENT MEETINGS"

"Totally understand. Even 5 minutes after a practice would help — I just want to know what you're building so I can reinforce it. No agenda."

IF SHE DOESN'T RESPOND IN 3-4 DAYS

"No pressure — just bumping this up. Happy to wait till things settle."
Then stop. Don't chase. Her silence is also information.

IF SHE SAYS SOMETHING YOU DON'T AGREE WITH

"That's helpful to hear. Let me sit with it."
This is not the moment to debate. You asked for her picture. You got it. Thank her and leave.

HOMEWORK

SEND THE TEXT TONIGHT.

- ✓ **Copy the pocket script from the previous slide.**
Or pull it from your Courtside library — it's saved as a printable script card.
- ✓ **Adjust the name. Send.**
Don't workshop it. Don't wait till the weekend.
- ✓ **When she answers — bring the four questions.**
Written down, on paper, not on your phone.

THE FINALE

WALKING THE
MAZE.

Pulling athlete, parent, and coach into one picture. The alignment ritual your family runs once a season.